Nathan Walters, M.S.
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Senior User Experience Lead | Human-Centered Design Strategist

Researcher and designer with over 7 years driving digital transformation across federal organizations. Proven success leading cross-functional Agile teams from ideation to value delivery. Strategic systems thinking approach to align teams around a problem domain, understanding root cause, and prioritizing deliverables.

User Interviews | Personas | Research Study Design | Wireframes | Usability Testing | Prototypes
Design Thinking | Service Blueprints | Journey Maps | Root-Cause Analysis
Figma | **Qualtrics** | **Tableau** | MIRO | Medallia | Balsamiq | JIRA | Excel
Study Design | Survey Creation | Qualitative & Quantitative Data Analysis | Data Visualization

Education

Embry-Riddle Aeronautical University

- **Master of Science** in Human Factors (concentration in **Systems Engineering**)
- Bachelor of Science in Human Factors Psychology (concentration in Human-Computer Interaction)

Professional Experience

Senior User Experience Lead
CGI - Woodlawn, MD *Jan 2026 – Present*

- Leading 9 designers and researchers directly to ensure consultant service delivery to federal clients.
- Leading 15 designers and researchers indirectly to ensure consultant service delivery to federal clients.
- Lead designer driving project enhancements through **designing with AI** blueprint for efficient delivery.

Senior Customer Experience Lead
Social Security Administration - Woodlawn, MD *Jan 2022 – Oct 2025*

- Led **mixed-method research** and analyzed qualitative and quantitative data to deliver findings that uncovered **usability** issues, process bottlenecks, and user **pain points.**
- Reduced in-person visits and phone calls, increased digital user engagement by **15%,** and boosted customer satisfaction by **2–3%** on a platform serving **30M monthly users**.
- Facilitated **design thinking workshops** to co-create, align stakeholders, and drive strategic implementation.
- Received **Commissioner Team Award** for building feedback access to the SSI 'Basic Needs' campaign.
- Reduced analysis time and scaled insights by applying **rule-based NLP AI** to categorize **1M+** open-ended responses annually for thematic analysis.
- Received **Commissioner Award** for designing and launching the agency's VoC platform.
- Used **Excel**, **Tableau,** and **Medallia** to analyze user feedback and build data visuals for leadership.
- See https://www.performance.gov/cx/data/ | Service Provider: Social Security Administration.

- Upskilled **300+ employees**—including executives—on VoC tools and led continuous improvement training.
- Received **2025 Service to the Citizen Team Award** for designing the Social Security Service Index.

User Experience Design Lead
Social Security Administration - Woodlawn, MD *Apr 2021 – Jan 2022*

- Facilitated **100+ interviews and usability tests** to uncover insights that improved product performance.
- Led a **four-person team** in redesigning mobile-first digital identity products, increasing user success rates from **~40%** to **~80%** through multi-year iterative, **user-centered research and design**.
- Created **longitudinal** research studies examining **staff** behaviors and **technology** usage during **customer** interactions—remotely and in-person.
- Earned **Commissioner Team Award** for delivering critical enhancements to Digital Identity Product.
- Built **personas** and facilitated **usability tests** across **product iterations** to guide strategic decisions.

UX Design Specialist
Northrop Grumman - Woodlawn, MD *Jan 2019 – Apr 2021*

- Developed **user flows** based on **ethnographic** research and **primary data** collection.
- Conducted **user research**, **usability testing**, and **prototyping** for digital identity authentication.
- Created **storyboards** and performed **heuristic evaluations** to improve digital products.
- Designed a chatbot interface for the Centers of Medicare and Medicaid Services in **HTML** and **CSS**.

Research Assistant
Embry-Riddle Aeronautical University - Daytona Beach, FL *May 2017 - Apr 2018*

- Facilitated **flight simulation studies** to gather **behavioral** data for flight safety.
- Led **market research** studies to understand user **perceptions** of automation products.
- Collected and analyzed **qualitative** and **quantitative** data using **NVIVO** and **SPSS** software programs.

Certifications

- **Certified Scrum Product Owner** | Scrum Alliance | August 2025
- **AI** and Career Empowerment | University of Maryland | July 2025
- **Lean Six Sigma Green Belt** | Project Management Institute | March 2025

Military Service

United States Army
Specialist (E-4) - Honorable Discharge *June 2004 –May 2010*

- Served as a Human Resources Information Systems Management specialist tracking and reporting casualty data during Operation Iraqi Freedom.
  Awards: Army Commendation Medal, Army Achievement Medal (4), Global War on Terrorism Service Medal, Korean Defense Service Medal, Iraq Campaign Medal with Campaign Star